



A Vanier Success Story

Vanier Children's Mental Wellness is a not-for-profit organization that has been serving children and families in London and Middlesex for over 50 years. As the lead agency for children's mental health in London Middlesex, Vanier offers a range of services for infants, children, and youth (up to 14 years old) and their families. Our programs and services are designed to provide mental health supports to families who have a child struggling with social, emotional, behavioural and mental health issues. Our services are offered by highly skilled healthcare professionals including Child Psychiatry, Child Psychology, Child and Family Therapists, Nursing, and Child and Youth Counsellors. Individual mental health treatment plans are co-designed with families in a collaborative manner to meet their needs. As an essential service our programs are open and continue to be offered in-person (following COVID protocols), over the phone, and virtually. Our services include mental health treatment and counselling, crisis supports, respite support for families, family support groups, peer support, school support, and live-in treatment. Most of our programs and services are supported through government funding and are offered at no cost to families. Vanier is committed to providing services that are equitable, diverse, and inclusive for everyone who needs us. We offer French language services, translation, and interpretation services.

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Matt was referred to Vanier's Intensive Services Program to receive assessment and intensive treatment to address ongoing sensory and mental health complexities in the classroom. Matt had anxiety at school and had challenges socializing. His academic progress was delayed, and he was bullied by his peers. Matt is supported at home by his mother, who had tried various programs and supports to determine why her son struggled academically and socially.

The Intensive Services Team consists of child and youth counselors, child and family therapists, teachers, psychologists, and psychiatry. The team support and collaborate with children and families when they are involved in Vanier's treatment classrooms and live-in treatment programs. Matt's inquisitive and curious nature made him gravitate towards fixating on his interests. His anxiety was driving impulsive behaviour that made it difficult to relate to others. He felt that people did not like him, and he was not sure why. Matt was diagnosed with Autism Spectrum Disorder which allowed for new treatment options that matched his neurodevelopment needs, steering him and his family towards the right services.

Vanier worked closely with Matt and his mother to explore how his needs may look different when working with new treatment. A new perspective was beginning to unfold for this family and hope and opportunity began to shine through.



Matt began to feel better about himself, experienced less anxiety and began having positive interactions with his peers through the treatment classroom.

Both Matt and his mom are proud of the progress they have made and the stronger relationship they have built. Matt now enjoys school and has additional classroom supports while he waits for placement in an Autism Spectrum Disorder Classroom. The family is truly thankful for the skills and strategies they learned at Vanier. Matt is on the right path for a bright future.

Crisis and Intake 519-433-0334. CIT is a partnership between Vanier Children's Mental Wellness, Craigwood Children, Youth and

Family Services, and WAYS Mental Health Support.

If you or a young person you know is struggling, please reach out for help. We are here you for 24/7, 365 days per year. We listen. We advocate. We champion children to find their victories every day.

**Caring. Supporting.
Transforming Lives.**

For more information about Vanier visit our website. www.vanier.com



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